

executive at Epson and told her about his idea of printing cells with a printer. The executive politely turned him down. A persistent Nakamura, however, got in touch with another Epson official who was interested in his idea, and agreed to provide technical support.

In 2003, Nakamura was able to get cells to survive the printing process, and the rest is history.

We're hoping that Nakamura succeeds, and answers the prayers of thousands of patients across the world.

A LITTLE BIG DELAY

PS3 Title 'Little Big Planet' Delayed

PlayStation has delayed the long-awaited launch of its PS3 title *Little Big Planet*. The reason for this is the discovery that background scores in the game are offensive to some users. This was brought to the notice of PlayStation by some users on their forum.

In the run-up to the launch, users said "Muslims consider the mixing of music and words from the Koran deeply offending. We hope you would remove that track from the game immediately via an online patch, and make sure that all future shipments of the game disk do not contain it." These were with regard to the lyrics and music of the track *Tapha Niang* by African kora player Toumani Diabate.

Little Big Planet is a puzzle-based game, where

you can customise and guide amusing characters to do some intriguing tasks. It was slated for a mid-October launch, but will now be released at a later date. The official word from PlayStation is "We have taken immediate action to rectify this and we sincerely apologise for any offence that this may have caused. Sorry for the delay, and rest assured, we are doing everything we can to get *Little Big Planet* to you as soon as possible."

The game was developed by Media Molecule, who were understandably taken aback by the developments. The game is already popular amongst critics and reviewers.

Media Molecule, in a statement, said that it takes the issue of offensive tracks seriously, and hopes that *Little Big Planet* will still be enjoyed by all.

Media Molecule has prepared a patch that will get rid of the offensive lyrics, which are believed to be Somali. Despite this patch being available, Sony has delayed the launch of the game as it wants to replace all existing disks. The song in question, however, has been uploaded by several users on YouTube in the past days.

Whether sales catch up or not, popularity has certainly caught up globally with the whole controversy. There's no such thing as bad publicity, is there?



AGAINST ANTI-PIRACY?

Chinese Not For Anti-Piracy Drives

Software giant Microsoft, in an effort to curb piracy across the globe had launched the Windows Genuine Advantage program. Aimed at detecting whether the software loaded on your system is genuine or pirated, it nags users of pirated Windows to buy a license. Although this move is not exactly welcomed by even genuine users, it's not surprising that the Chinese are against it, considering the rampant piracy there.

Over the years, Microsoft has not taken a tough stand on its Windows operating system being widely pirated globally. However, with the financial crunch hitting companies globally, Microsoft values your dollars even more.

A couple of years ago, prior to the launch of Office

2007, Microsoft had launched an anti-piracy drive in the UK. Microsoft had then made a statement that it believed upto 63 per cent of Microsoft Office installs in the UK could be pirated. Michala Alexander, head of anti-piracy for Microsoft UK says that the company's investigations have revealed only the tip of a counterfeiting iceberg in the UK. Alexander said, "Piracy costs Microsoft at least \$250 million a year in lost sales. The problem is phenomenal. We had

set up a Web site, Office Genuine Advantage, to allow users to go online to validate their Office software, and in three months, 4,000 people have attempted to validate their software with 63 per cent discovering they were running an illegal copy."

Microsoft is hoping to cash in on those who may not have intentionally pirated their products — such as people who buy systems with pre-installed pirated software, or those who don't know that you cannot install from a friend's CD.

Taking the fight global should significantly increase revenues, considering the higher rate of piracy across the globe.

A furious blogger on a Chinese site said, "Why is Microsoft automatically connected with my computer? The computer is mine! Microsoft has no right to control my computer without my agreement."

While Microsoft is justified in taking a stand at protecting its intellectual property,

STAT ATTACK

It's all in the numbers

Yahoo to cut 1500 jobs after reporting losses

Google's \$10 million project idea competition attracted 150,000 ideas

Internet usage is increasing faster than world population

Symbian OS has 74% share in smartphones

80% of digital cameras sold in the US in 2008 were 8-megapixel or higher

Almost 7 million iPhones were sold in the 4th quarter of 08 — so far

Internet penetration of the world population is 22.19%

whether users in China, the world's fastest growing market, decide to switch to genuine Windows or change their operating system will decide whether this move by Microsoft was wise at all.



EVEN MORE DTH

Airtel Launches DTH Service In India

Expect to familiarise yourself with another one of those small branded dish antennae hanging outside people's home. Bharti Telemedia, has followed close on the heels of ADAG's Big TV with its Direct to Home (DTH) service called 'Digital TV' on October 9. This brings the total number of DTH

services in India to six, with Dish TV, Sun Direct, Tata Sky and DD Direct plus being the other players in the field.

The launch was relatively low profile compared to the grand launch of Reliance Big TV. The service is available in 62 cities/towns and 21,000 retail points across the country. Digital TV will be offering 175 channels using the MPEG-4 technology, and is HD-ready. The packages offered vary between zones, prices start at Rs 2,499 in the North Indian market, and Rs 1,499 in the South Indian market. Included are ten World Space channels, and a single remote for both the TV and the Set-top-box, which is a first for DTH services in India.

The entry of Big TV and Digital TV has started off a huge price war between DTH service providers, with all of them trying to grab a foothold.

Dish TV and Tata Sky have slashed prices (to as low as Rs 100 per month), introduced new and innovative packages, and are amping up the bells and whistles of the service in terms of providing value added services and interactive content.

It is in this last area that Digital TV is hoping to excel. Using the Infosys Digital Convergence Platform, Digital TV is offering local news, weather and traffic reports, offering user customisable widgets, and a host of other

interactive content. Also in the offing are applications with iCity, iNet and tPortal which allows for an Internet-like experience on your television, without interrupting your viewing pleasure. More applications from Infosys are in the pipeline as well.

Currently, there are 7.5 million DTH users in the country, with Dish TV broadcasting to 4 million pairs of eyeballs, and clearly in the lead. Tata Sky, Sun Direct and Big TV in that order are the next biggest players. DD Direct plus is only popular in the more remote regions of the country, and offers only free content at present. The market is expected to expand rapidly in the next few years, particularly in rural areas.

GOOGLE MAKES MORE MONEY

Google Finds Innovative Ways To Get Cash In The Kitty

Google continues to be on the bleeding edge of advertising proliferation. Now they have invaded the sacred space of online gaming. Their new technology, dubbed AdSense for Gaming beta shamelessly inserts video, image or text ads at the beginning, middle and end of levels in an online game.

Buzzword of the MONTH

Buzzword

No, we're not kidding. Buzzword is an online word processor from the folks at Adobe. Head over to <http://buzzword.acrobat.com>. Its free but you have to sign up.

You can save your documents online, so you can access it from anywhere, have an unlimited number of people collaborate on it, control versions and keep track of

changes. The word processor can handle images, give selective access to collaborators based on their roles, and a nifty little document dashboard for easy access to all your documents. Buzzword supports TXT, RTF, DOC, DOCX, PDF, ODT and HTML formats. Buzzword has spell-check support for 18 languages. The only bummer is that it does not have native support for Opera.